TABLE TALK

How to play

1. Shuffle the deck and set it in the middle of the table.
2. Take turns drawing a card. Read the saying aloud, then the question.
3. Anyone can answer, in any order. Listen well, and let each person finish.
4. Pass is always a fine answer. No one has to share more than they want to.

♥ LOVE ♦ COURAGE ♣ PEACE ♠ GRACE

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Ways to use the deck

1. Family dinner: one card a night, or a few on a slow evening.
2. Small groups: draw three to open a meeting, or pick one suit for the evening.
3. Couples: take a card on a walk or over coffee.
4. The sayings are from the King James Version, in the words of Jesus as the Gospels record them.

RED LETTER · KING JAMES VERSION

1 ♥ LOVE

A new commandment I give unto you, That ye love one another; as I have loved you, that ye also love one another.

JOHN 13:34

Who has shown you what love looks like, and what did they do?

1 ♠

2 ♥ LOVE

Greater love hath no man than this, that a man lay down his life for his friends.

JOHN 15:13

What is something a friend might give up to help someone they love?

2 ♠

3 ♥ LOVE

Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.

MARK 12:31

Who lives or works near you, and how could you look after them this week?

3 ♠

4 ♥ LOVE

And as ye would that men should do to you, do ye also to them likewise.

LUKE 6:31

What kind thing would you love someone to do for you, and who could you do it for?

4 ♠

5 ♥ LOVE

For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.

MATTHEW 6:21

If someone watched how you spend your time, what would they say you treasure?

5 ♠

6 ♥ LOVE

Love your enemies, do good to them which hate you

LUKE 6:27

What makes it hard to be kind to someone who has been unkind to you?

6 ♠

7 ♥ LOVE

I have called you friends

JOHN 15:15

What makes someone a true friend?

7 ♠

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8 ♥ LOVE

For I was an hungred, and ye gave me meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me drink: I was a stranger, and ye took me in

MATTHEW 25:35

How could we make someone new feel welcome at our table or in our group?

8 ♠

9 ♥ LOVE

Inasmuch as ye have done it unto one of the least of these my brethren, ye have done it unto me.

MATTHEW 25:40

Who is easy to overlook, and how could we notice them more?

9 ♠

10 ♥ LOVE

As the Father hath loved me, so have I loved you: continue ye in my love.

JOHN 15:9

What helps you remember that you are loved, even on a hard day?

10 ♠

11 ♥ LOVE

Suffer the little children to come unto me, and forbid them not: for of such is the kingdom of God.

MARK 10:14

What is something children understand better than grown-ups do?

11 ♠

12 ♥ LOVE

Feed my sheep.

JOHN 21:17

What are some ways people take care of each other without using any words?

12 ♠

13 ♥ LOVE

If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; ye also ought to wash one another's feet.

JOHN 13:14

What everyday job shows love, and who does it for you?

13 ♠

1 ♦ COURAGE

Be of good cheer; it is I; be not afraid.

MATTHEW 14:27

What is something that used to scare you but doesn't anymore, and what changed?

1 ♦

2 ♦ COURAGE

Be not afraid, only believe.

MARK 5:36

What helps you feel brave when you are nervous?

2 ♦

3 ♦ COURAGE

Ye are the light of the world. A city that is set on an hill cannot be hid.

MATTHEW 5:14

What gift do you see in someone at this table that the world needs?

3 ♦

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4 COURAGE

Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven.

MATTHEW 5:16

What good thing have you seen someone do lately that made you smile?

4

5 COURAGE

With men this is impossible; but with God all things are possible.

MATTHEW 19:26

What is something that seemed impossible at first but turned out to be possible?

5

6 COURAGE

Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you.

LUKE 11:9

What would you love to learn or try if you knew you could not fail?

6

7 COURAGE

In the world ye shall have tribulation: but be of good cheer; I have overcome the world.

JOHN 16:33

What helps a person keep going when things get hard?

7

8 COURAGE

And ye shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free.

JOHN 8:32

Why can telling the truth feel scary, and why is it worth it?

8

9 COURAGE

Rise, take up thy bed, and walk.

JOHN 5:8

What is a small first step toward something you have been wanting to do?

9

10 COURAGE

Fear not, little flock; for it is your Father's good pleasure to give you the kingdom.

LUKE 12:32

Who cheers you on, and how does that change what you are willing to try?

10

11 COURAGE

As my Father hath sent me, even so send I you.

JOHN 20:21

If you could be sent anywhere in the world to help people, where would you go?

11

12 COURAGE

But even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. Fear not therefore: ye are of more value than many sparrows.

LUKE 12:7

What is something about you that makes you one of a kind?

12

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13 COURAGE

And whosoever shall compel thee to go a mile, go with him twain.

MATTHEW 5:41

What does it look like to go the extra mile for someone?

13

1 PEACE

Peace, be still.

MARK 4:39

Where do you go, or what do you do, when you need to feel calm?

1

2 PEACE

Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you ... Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid.

JOHN 14:27

What does peace feel like to you, and where do you find it?

2

3 PEACE

Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.

MATTHEW 11:28

What is your favorite way to rest after a long day?

3

4 PEACE

Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feedeth them.

MATTHEW 6:26

What can we learn from watching birds, animals and the rest of nature?

4

5 PEACE

Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow; they toil not, neither do they spin

MATTHEW 6:28

What is something beautiful you noticed this week?

5

6 PEACE

Take therefore no thought for the morrow: for the morrow shall take thought for the things of itself.

MATTHEW 6:34

What helps you set aside worries about tomorrow and enjoy today?

6

7 PEACE

Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God.

MATTHEW 5:9

What is a good way to help two friends who are arguing make peace?

7

8 PEACE

Come ye yourselves apart into a desert place, and rest a while.

MARK 6:31

If we had a whole day with nothing planned, how would you want to spend it?

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9 PEACE

Martha, Martha, thou art careful and troubled about many things ... But one thing is needful

LUKE 10:41–42

When life gets busy, what is the one thing you most want to make time for?

9

10 PEACE

Come and dine.

JOHN 21:12

What is your favorite meal to share with people you love, and why?

10

11 PEACE

In my Father's house are many mansions ... I go to prepare a place for you.

JOHN 14:2

What makes a place feel like home to you?

11

12 PEACE

Have peace one with another.

MARK 9:50

What are some things that help a family or a group get along well?

12

13 PEACE

Peace be unto you.

LUKE 24:36

How can we tell when someone needs a little peace, and what could we do?

13

1 GRACE

I say not unto thee, Until seven times: but, Until seventy times seven.

MATTHEW 18:22

Jesus said to forgive seventy times seven. Why do you think forgiving can be so hard?

1

2 GRACE

Father, forgive them; for they know not what they do.

LUKE 23:34

How does it feel when someone forgives you?

2

3 GRACE

Be ye therefore merciful, as your Father also is merciful.

LUKE 6:36

What does it mean to give someone a second chance?

3

4 GRACE

Judge not, and ye shall not be judged: condemn not, and ye shall not be condemned: forgive, and ye shall be forgiven

LUKE 6:37

What might we miss about a person when we judge them too quickly?

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5 GRACE

There is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner that repenteth.

LUKE 15:10

Who is always glad to see you, and how can you tell?

5

6 GRACE

Rejoice, because your names are written in heaven.

LUKE 10:20

What good news from this week could we celebrate together?

6

7 GRACE

For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost.

LUKE 19:10

How can we help someone who feels left out?

7

8 GRACE

Neither do I condemn thee: go, and sin no more.

JOHN 8:11

What helps someone make a fresh start after a mistake?

8

9 GRACE

Freely ye have received, freely give.

MATTHEW 10:8

What is something you have been given that you would love to pass on?

9

10 GRACE

This poor widow hath cast more in, than all they which have cast into the treasury

MARK 12:43

Why can a small gift sometimes mean more than a big one?

10

11 GRACE

And why beholdest thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye, but considerest not the beam that is in thine own eye?

MATTHEW 7:3

Why is it easier to spot other people's mistakes than our own?

11

12 GRACE

These things have I spoken unto you, that my joy might remain in you, and that your joy might be full.

JOHN 15:11

What fills you with joy, even on an ordinary day?

12

13 GRACE

Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy.

MATTHEW 5:7

Who do you know who is good at being gentle with others, and what do they do?

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